

GKUC SiteOps

How to use the system, from start to finish

This guide is written for everyone who uses SiteOps — site supervisors, store keepers, the quantity surveying team, the office and management. You do not need to know anything about computers to follow it. Every section tells you what to click and what will happen.

Read the first three sections before you start. After that, read only the section for the work you do.

Prepared for GKUC Construction (Pvt) Ltd
Built by Infinity AI

What is in this guide

	Section	What it covers
1	What SiteOps is for	Why the company uses it
2	Getting started	Signing in and looking after your account
3	Finding your way around	The menu, the bell, the search button
4	A normal working day	What happens, and who does it
5	Projects and sites	Starting a project and keeping it up to date
6	Bills of quantities	Building one in the system, or uploading from Excel
7	Quotations and invoices	Turning a BOQ into a price for the client
8	Tenders	Keeping track of what you have bid for
9	Materials and the store	Stock, orders and what has been lent out
10	Vehicles and equipment	Where they are and when papers expire
11	People and attendance	Who is on site, leave and pay
12	Money	What has been spent and what has come in
13	Site photographs	Proving how a site looked
14	Messages and alerts	WhatsApp, the bell and the sound
15	Finding old documents	Searching inside scanned paperwork
16	Who is allowed to do what	Roles and permissions
17	Changing the dropdown choices	Adding your own categories and types
18	Messaging your colleagues	Chats and groups inside the system
19	The fraud and mistake watch	What the system checks for on its own
20	The document drive	Storing and sharing files
21	Billing the client	Certificates, VAT and SVAT, retention and bonds
22	Petty cash	The float held on each site
23	The HR registers	The muster roll and the leave register
24	Lending tools out	Due-back dates and what comes back

Section		What it covers
25	The evening summary	The message that goes to the Managing Director
26	If something looks wrong	Simple things to check first

1. What SiteOps is for

SiteOps holds the day-to-day running of the company in one place. Before, the same information sat in different notebooks, spreadsheets and phones. Now everyone works from the same picture.

It keeps track of:

- Every project, how far along it is and what it has cost so far
- Who is on site each day, and who is on leave
- Bills of quantities, quotations and invoices
- Tenders you have bid for, and their closing dates
- Materials in the store, what has been ordered and what has been lent out
- Vehicles and equipment, and when their papers run out
- Photographs of each site, from the first day onwards
- Every document you upload — contracts, drawings, scanned paperwork

The system also watches for things that need attention and tells you before they become a problem — a tender closing, a vehicle licence expiring, stock running low.

2. Getting started

Signing in

- 1 Open your web browser and go to the address the office gave you.
- 2 Type your email address and your password.
- 3 Click **Sign in**.

You will see your own name at the top right of the screen. If you see somebody else's name, sign out and sign in again with your own details.

Your password

Your password must be at least 12 characters long and must mix capital letters, small letters and numbers or symbols. This sounds long, but a short sentence works well — something you will remember and nobody else would guess.

- Never share your password, not even with a colleague you trust.
- Never write it on a note stuck to the screen.
- To change it, click your name at the top right and choose **My account**.

The system knows who did what

Everything you do is recorded against your name — every price changed, every record approved, every document uploaded. If you let somebody else use your account, their actions will look like yours.

Signing out

Click your name at the top right and choose **Sign out**. The system also signs you out on its own after an hour of doing nothing, so a screen left open in the site office cannot be used by somebody walking past.

The first time you sign in

A short introduction appears the first time you use SiteOps. It moves through the screens you are allowed to open, one at a time, explaining what each is for. It takes about a minute.

- 1 Press **Next** to move on, or **Back** to see a step again.
- 2 Press **Skip the introduction** at any point if you would rather get on.
- 3 It does not come back once you have finished or skipped it.

You will not see every step. The introduction only covers the parts of the system your role can open — a store keeper is not walked through payroll. That is the correct tour for that person, not a shortened one.

To see it again

Click your name in the top corner and choose **Show me around again**. It starts from the beginning, and works on a phone as well as a computer.

3. Finding your way around

The menu runs along the top of the screen. On a phone, tap the three lines at the top left to open it.

Menu item	What you will find there
Dashboard	The first screen. A summary of today — who is on site, what needs attention, how projects are going.
Coordination	Moving people, vehicles and equipment between sites.
Projects	Every project, its budget, progress and team.
Tasks	Jobs given to people, with dates they are due.
Quantity Surveying	Bills of quantities, quotations, tenders, retention and subcontractors.
People	Employees, attendance, leave and payroll.
Materials	Stock in the store, purchase requests and orders.
Fleet	Vehicles, equipment and their documents.
Finance	Money spent and money received.
Daily reports	What happened on site each day.
Administration	Accounts, permissions and settings. Management only.

Three buttons at the top right

Button	What it does
Magnifying glass	Searches <i>inside</i> your documents — even scanned ones. See section 15.
Speaker	Turns the alert sound on or off. Your choice is remembered on this device.
Bell	Shows your alerts. A red dot means something new. A small green dot underneath means the system is live.

The screen updates by itself

You do not need to refresh the page. When somebody else adds a task, records attendance or approves a document, your screen changes within a second. If the green dot under the bell disappears, your internet connection has dropped — it will reconnect on its own.

4. A normal working day

This is the rhythm the system is built around. Not everybody does all of it — do the part that belongs to your job.

Morning

Who	What they do
Site supervisor	Opens People → Attendance and marks who has come to site. Anyone arriving after the agreed time is marked late automatically.
Store keeper	Checks Materials for anything running low and raises a purchase request.
Coordinator	Looks at the Dashboard to see what needs attention today, and moves people or vehicles between sites if needed.
Everyone	Checks the bell for alerts.

During the day

Who	What they do
Site supervisor	Marks tasks finished as the work is done. Takes photographs of progress and adds them to the project gallery.
Store keeper	Records materials going out to site, and tools lent to workers.
QS team	Prepares bills of quantities and quotations. Keeps tender dates up to date.
Office	Records money received and bills paid.

End of the day

Who	What they do
Site supervisor	Writes the daily report: what was done, how many people worked, the weather, and any problem that held work up.
Store keeper	Marks returned tools as returned.
Management	Reviews what is waiting for approval.

Write the daily report the same day

It is the record of what happened on site. If there is a dispute about delays months later, this report and the site photographs are what settle it. Written a week later from memory, it is worth very little.

5. Projects and sites

Starting a new project

- 1 Go to **Projects** and click **Add project**.
- 2 Fill in the name, the client, where the site is, and the start and finish dates.
- 3 Put in the contract value as the budget.
- 4 Save. The project now appears on the dashboard.

Keeping it up to date

- **Progress** — update the percentage as work moves on. The dashboard uses this.
- **Team** — add the people working on the site so the system knows where everyone is.
- **Health** — mark a project *At risk* as soon as you think it may slip. It is better to raise it early.
- **Documents** — upload the contract, drawings and approvals against the project.

Moving people between sites

If a site stops — rain, a hold-up, a permit — open **Coordination** and reschedule it. Choose where the crew should go instead. The system moves the people, vehicles and equipment across, records that it happened, and tells everyone affected.

6. Bills of quantities

A bill of quantities — a BOQ — is the priced list of work. Everything else is built from it: the quotation you send the client, the invoices, and the budget the project is measured against.

There are **two ways** to make one, and both are equally supported. Go to **Quantity Surveying** and open the **Bills of quantities** tab. The two choices are side by side at the top of the screen.

Choose	When it suits	What happens
Build it here	A short bill, or when you are pricing as you go.	A form opens. Add lines one at a time and save.
Bring it in from Excel	A long bill, or one already priced in a spreadsheet.	Download the template, fill it in, upload it, check it, approve it.

Way 1: build it in the system

- 1 Go to **Quantity Surveying** and open the **Bills of quantities** tab.
- 2 Click **Build it here**.
- 3 Choose the project and give the bill a title.
- 4 Add each line of work: the category, what it is, the unit, the quantity and the rate.
- 5 Click **Add line** for each further item. The running total is shown at the bottom.
- 6 The system multiplies quantity by rate for you. Do not work out the amounts yourself.

The **Category** dropdown offers the categories your company uses. If the one you need is missing, it can be added — see section 17.

Uploading a BOQ from another company

Bills arrive from consultants, clients and other contractors, laid out however their office does it. You do not need to retype them into our template — upload the file as it is and the system works out which column is which.

- 1 Upload the file the same way as our own template.
- 2 A blue box appears saying the layout was worked out, and showing which column it read as the description, the quantity, the rate and so on. **Check that box first.**
- 3 Section headings and subtotal lines are left out, so a "Sub Total" row is not imported as though it were work to be done.
- 4 Their item numbers are kept in the notes on each line, so a line can be traced back to their document.

Their bill will not have our categories

No other company groups work the way we do, so every line will be flagged as needing a category. Rather than setting two hundred of them one at a time, use **Set every line still missing a category to** at the top of the checking screen — choose one and press Apply.

If their bill gives an amount but no rate, the system works the rate back by dividing the amount by the quantity, and says so on the line. That is arithmetic of ours, not a figure they quoted, so it is worth a look before you approve it.

The original file is kept

Every spreadsheet uploaded is stored exactly as it arrived, and stays reachable from the bill it produced — click **The original file** on the checking screen. A bill priced by somebody else is a commercial document: it is what was quoted, by whom, and when. Keeping it means a figure can always be checked against the paper it came from, which matters in a dispute.

Way 2: upload a BOQ you made in Excel

Most estimators are faster in Excel. You can work there and bring the finished BOQ into the system.

- 1 On the same screen, click **Download the template**. This gives you an Excel file with the right columns and an example row. There is a second sheet called **Instructions** explaining each column.
- 2 Fill it in. One line of work per row.
- 3 Come back to the same screen and click **Upload a filled-in BOQ**.
- 4 The system reads your file and shows you everything it found. **Nothing is saved yet**.
- 5 Check the list. Fix anything marked in orange by clicking on it and typing.
- 6 Choose the project, then click **Approve and create the BOQ**.

Leave the Amount column empty

The system multiplies quantity by rate itself. If you type an amount that does not match, it will tell you and use $\text{quantity} \times \text{rate}$. This is deliberate: it means a typing mistake in one column cannot quietly change a price.

What the checking screen shows you

You will see	What it means	What to do
Orange row with a warning	The system could not understand something — a category spelled differently, a quantity that is not a number, a missing rate.	Click on the value and correct it. Or untick the row to leave it out.
Blue note	Something worth knowing, but not a mistake. Usually the amount in your file not matching $\text{quantity} \times \text{rate}$.	Nothing. Read it and carry on.
Tick box on the left	Whether the row will be included.	Untick anything you do not want — headings, blank lines, notes to yourself.

You cannot save until every orange row is either corrected or unticked. This is on purpose. A BOQ with a line nobody could read becomes a quotation with a wrong price.

Changing a BOQ after it has been approved

While a BOQ is a **draft**, you can edit it freely. Once it has been **approved**, it is locked — because quotations, invoices and the project budget are now built on those figures.

- 1 Open the BOQ and ask for the change you need, giving the reason.
- 2 The Managing Director is told straight away.

- 3 Nothing changes until they approve it. If they do, the new figure is applied and the BOQ total is corrected. If they reject it, nothing changes and you are told why.

The Managing Director can give this approval power to somebody else — the QS head, for example — from **Administration** → **Access control**.

7. Quotations and invoices

A quotation is built from an approved BOQ. You never retype the prices — they are copied across, which is why they always match.

- 1 Go to **Quantity Surveying** → **Quotations** and click **Create quotation**.
- 2 Choose the BOQ it is based on.
- 3 Add your mark-up percentage if you are adding one.
- 4 Check the total, then save.
- 5 Click **PDF** to produce the document to send the client.

When the client accepts, mark the quotation **Accepted**. The system then knows the work is confirmed and the figures feed into the project.

If a subcontractor gives you a price

Record the subcontractor's quotation in the **Subcontractors** tab. You can then carry that price into your own quotation with your mark-up added, and the system remembers where the figure came from. It will also warn you when a subcontractor's price is about to run out of validity.

8. Tenders

The tenders section keeps track of everything you have bid for, so nothing is missed because a date passed unnoticed.

- Record the tender: who it is for, the reference, and the closing date and time.
- List the documents the tender asks for, and tick them off as they are prepared.
- The system counts down to the closing date and warns you as it approaches.
- It will not let you mark a tender submitted while required documents are still missing.
- When you hear the result, record it. If you won, the tender can become a project.

9. Materials and the store

Everyday use

- **Receiving materials** — record what arrived, from which supplier, and the cost.
- **Issuing to site** — record what went out and to which project. The cost goes against that project.
- **Lending tools** — record who took what, and mark it returned when it comes back.

Ordering

- 1 Raise a **purchase request** saying what is needed and when.
- 2 Management approves or rejects it.
- 3 Once approved, it becomes a purchase order to the supplier.
- 4 When the goods arrive, record the receipt. Stock goes up automatically.

Set the minimum level for every material

The system warns you when stock falls below it. Without a minimum level it cannot warn you, and you find out you are short when the site calls.

10. Vehicles and equipment

- Record every vehicle with its registration, and every piece of equipment with its code.
- Say which project each one is on, so you always know where things are.
- Add the expiry dates for insurance, licence, emission test and any other document.
- The system warns you before each one runs out. An expired licence stops a lorry, and stops the work it was carrying.
- Record services and repairs so a vehicle's history stays with it.

Equipment can carry a printed code that a phone camera can read, so a tool can be checked in and out quickly on site.

11. People and attendance

Attendance

Mark attendance every morning. You can enter it by hand, or upload the export file from a fingerprint machine and the system will read it.

- Anyone arriving after the agreed start time is marked late automatically.
- Attendance feeds payroll, so getting it right each day saves arguments at month end.

Leave

An employee asks for leave, a manager approves or rejects it, and the system keeps the balance. Approved leave shows on the attendance screen, so nobody is marked absent when they were allowed the day off.

Pay

Payroll uses the attendance already recorded. Staff on a monthly salary and workers on a daily rate are both handled. Check the figures before approving a pay run — once approved, payslips can be produced.

12. Money

- **Expenses** — every cost recorded against the project it belongs to.
- **Income** — every payment received, with the date it actually arrived.
- **Retention** — money the client holds back until the defects period ends. Record the release date and the system will chase it for you.

The dashboard compares what a project has cost against its budget. This only tells the truth if costs are recorded as they happen, so record them the same week.

Retention is real money

It is the most commonly forgotten income in construction. Record it with its release date the moment the contract is signed, and the system will remind you when it is due.

13. Site photographs

The gallery is the picture record of a site. On the very first day, before any work starts, photograph every corner of the plot. That set of photographs is your proof of how the ground was handed to you.

- 1 Open the project and go to **Gallery**.
- 2 Make folders for the different parts of the work.
- 3 Upload photographs, or take them with the camera on your phone.

Every photograph is stamped with the date and time it was added. **That stamp can never be changed by anybody, including management.** This is what makes the gallery worth having: a photograph nobody can back-date is evidence.

A photograph added by mistake can be withdrawn from view, but the record that it existed remains. Nothing is ever silently deleted.

14. Messages and alerts

Alerts inside the system

The bell at the top right shows things that need attention: a tender closing, a licence expiring, stock running low, a task overdue. A message also slides in at the top right of your screen when something important happens, with a sound. Turn the sound off with the speaker button if you are in a meeting.

WhatsApp messages

Important alerts can also be sent to people's phones on WhatsApp, so a supervisor on site hears about them without opening the system.

To send a message yourself:

- 1 Go to **Administration** → **Messages**.
- 2 Choose who it goes to. You can pick people one by one, add a whole site team at once, or type a number for somebody who is not on the system — a supplier, for example.
- 3 Write your message and click **Send**.
- 4 You will see exactly who it reached. Anyone without a phone number on file is shown as skipped, so you know to follow up another way.

Only certain people can send WhatsApp messages

These messages go out under the company's name and cost money for each one. The Managing Director decides who is allowed, from **Administration** → **Access control**.

15. Finding old documents

Click the magnifying glass at the top right and type what you remember. This does not just search file names — it searches the words *inside* your documents.

When you upload a document, the system reads it in the background. A few seconds later you can find it by any word it contains: a supplier's name, a reference number, an amount. This works for scanned paperwork and photographs of documents, as well as ordinary files.

For example, typing a supplier name will find:

- A scanned quotation from that supplier from two years ago
- A contract that mentions them
- A photograph of a delivery note with their name on it

Handwriting cannot be read

The system reads printed and typed documents well. It cannot read handwriting. Handwritten site records are still worth uploading — they are stored safely and you can find them by project and date — but you will not be able to search the words inside them.

You will only ever see documents you are allowed to see. A search by a store keeper will never show a payslip or an employment contract.

16. Who is allowed to do what

Everybody has a role, and each role can do certain things. This is why two people can look at the same screen and see different buttons.

Role	What they can do
Managing Director	Everything, including deciding what everyone else may do.
Assistant to the MD	Manages user accounts and helps run the system day to day.
Project Coordinator	Runs projects, moves people and vehicles, sees most things.
QS Department Head	Bills of quantities, quotations, tenders and retention.
Finance Department Head	Money in and out, invoices and payments.
HR Department Head	Employees, leave, attendance and payroll.
Transport Department Head	Vehicles, equipment and their documents.
Site Supervisor	Daily reports, tasks, attendance and site photographs.
Store Keeper	Stock, goods received and tools lent out.
Read-Only Viewer	Can look, cannot change anything.

The Managing Director can change what any role is allowed to do, and can also give one person an extra permission without changing their whole role. This is done in **Administration** → **Access control**.

If you cannot see something you think you need, ask the Managing Director rather than borrowing somebody else's login.

17. Changing the dropdown choices

Many forms ask you to choose from a list — the category of a BOQ line, the type of leave, which paper on a vehicle is expiring. Those lists belong to the company, not to the software, and they can be changed without anybody touching the system.

Where to find them

- 1 Go to **Administration** and open the **Lists** tab.
- 2 The lists are grouped by department, so the ones you want are together.
- 3 Click **Add** beside a list to add a choice, type the name, and press Enter.

What you can do to a choice

Action	What it does
Rename (pencil)	Changes the wording everywhere, including on records that already use it. A report on last year still reads correctly.
Turn off (crossed eye)	Stops it being offered on new records. Anything already using it is untouched. Use this rather than deleting.
Delete (bin)	Only offered for choices your company added, and only while nothing uses them.

A change takes effect immediately. Somebody with a form already open on another screen will see the new choice appear without reloading anything.

Some choices have a padlock

A very small number of words are read by the system to decide what to do. **Unpaid** leave is the example: payroll finds unpaid days by looking for that exact word, so renaming it would quietly stop the deduction. Those are marked with a padlock and can be reordered but not renamed or turned off.

What is not on this screen

Words like **Draft**, **Approved**, **Pending** and **Completed** are not there, and that is deliberate. They are not labels — the system reads them to decide what happens next. An invoice that is **Approved** can be paid. A BOQ that is **Approved** locks and needs permission to change. A tender that is **Submitted** stops warning you about its closing date.

A status somebody invented would be a word nothing in the system knows how to act on, and the record would sit in a state nobody could move it out of. If you need a new stage in a workflow, that is a change to the system itself — ask the office.

18. Messaging your colleagues

You can message anybody who uses SiteOps without leaving it. A supervisor asking the storekeeper whether the cement arrived should not have to pick up a personal phone — and when that conversation happens on WhatsApp, the company has no record of what was agreed.

Starting a conversation

- 1 Open **Chat** from the menu.
- 2 Press **+** at the top of the list.
- 3 Choose a person to message them directly, or **New group** for a site team.
- 4 Type at the bottom and press Enter. Shift and Enter together starts a new line.

The ticks beside your message

Mark	What it means
One tick	The system has your message. It has not reached them yet — their phone or computer may be off.
Two grey ticks	It reached them. In a group, it reached everybody.
Two blue ticks	They opened the conversation and saw it. In a group, everybody did.

Beside somebody's name you will see **Online** if they are using the system now, or when they were last on it. A group shows how many people are in it.

Withdrawing a message

Hover over anything you sent and press the bin to withdraw it. It is replaced with “This message was withdrawn” rather than disappearing — the fact that something was said and taken back stays visible, which is the honest way round.

19. The fraud and mistake watch

Every few hours the system reads back through its own records looking for things that are not right. Some of what it finds is dishonesty; far more of it is ordinary human error. Both cost the company money, and both look the same in the records until somebody checks.

What it looks for

It notices	Why that matters
A cost far outside the usual for its kind	Compared against what that sort of cost normally is on that project — not a fixed limit, because unusual for fuel and unusual for a subcontract are different numbers.
A figure that looks like a typing slip	If moving the decimal point one or two places makes it an ordinary figure, it says so and suggests the amount that was probably meant.
Orders split to stay under the approval limit	Four orders of 240,000 to one supplier in a week, where one order of 960,000 would have needed sign-off.
The same invoice billed twice	Same supplier, same amount, days apart — under a slightly different invoice number.
Paying more than was invoiced	Money leaving the company that no invoice asks for.
Attendance for somebody who is on no employee record	Either a person was taken on without a contract or rate, or a day's pay is being drawn for somebody who does not exist.
A whole gang checked in at the identical second	Real arrivals scatter over several minutes. Identical times mean the day was filled in afterwards.
More material issued than was ever received	Either receipts were never entered, or material left without being bought.
Spending far ahead of progress	80% of the budget gone for 40% of the work.

Nothing is blocked

The watch raises things for a person to look at. It does not refuse entries. A system that stops a legitimate unusual entry at six in the evening on a pour day gets worked around within a week — and then the company has neither the control nor the record. The only things refused outright are the ones that cannot be right under any reading, and those were already refused before this existed.

Looking at what it found

- 1 Go to **Administration** and open the **Fraud watch** tab.
- 2 Findings are ranked worst first. Click one to see the detail and the figures behind it.
- 3 Say what you found when you looked, then choose **Not a problem**, **This is real** or **Dealt with**.

Write the note, even when it is nothing

Saying why matters more than which button you press. Six months from now, the note is the only thing that says whether somebody checked this properly or just cleared it off the list. The system will not let you dismiss a finding without one.

A finding is not an accusation. Most of them turn out to be a genuine bulk delivery, a legitimate late night, or a figure that only looks odd without the paperwork beside it. The point is that somebody looked.

Adjusting what counts as normal

Under **What counts as normal** on the same screen, every figure the checks compare against can be changed — the approval limit, how far from usual counts as unusual, how many hours of overtime is too many. A rule nobody can adjust is a rule that gets switched off the first time it is wrong.

20. The document drive

The drive is the company's own store for files — drawings, contracts, photographs, anything. It works the way Google Drive or OneDrive does: folders you arrange yourself, and sharing you control per item.

- 1 Open **Drive** from the menu.
- 2 Press **New folder** to make one, or **Upload** to add files. You can also drag files onto the page.
- 3 Click a folder to go into it. The trail across the top shows where you are.
- 4 Click a file to download it.

Everything starts private

Anything you put in the drive can be seen by you alone until you share it. Nothing is visible to colleagues by accident.

Deciding who can see something

Press the share button on any row. There are four levels, and they build on each other:

Level	Who can reach it
Only me	Nobody else, whatever folder it sits in.
People I choose	Only the colleagues you name. Each can be set to view or to edit.
Everybody in the company	Anybody who can sign in to SiteOps, viewing or editing as you choose.
Anyone with the link	A web address that works without signing in. For a client or a consultant.

Sharing a **folder** shares everything inside it. That is what most people expect, and it saves sharing a hundred files one at a time.

The public link is the one exception

A public link applies to that one file and nothing else. A file does **not** become public because a folder above it was made public, and a folder cannot be made public at all. This is deliberate: everything else in the drive spreads downwards, and a payslip reachable by anyone with a web address is not a mistake worth risking. Making something public is always a decision somebody took about that one file, and it is recorded against their name.

Public links

- 1 Open the sharing panel and press **Create a link**.
- 2 Copy it and send it to whoever needs the file.

- 3 The panel shows how many times it has been downloaded.
- 4 Press **Turn off** when it has served its purpose. The link stops working at once.

Only the owner of a file can create or withdraw a public link — somebody you gave editing rights to can change the file, but cannot publish it to the world.

Asking for access

If a colleague sends you a link to something you cannot open, you can ask for access and say why. The owner is notified and can let you in with one click. That is better than a phone call they forget, and better than working around the system.

What the drive will not take

Programs. Anything that would run on the computer of whoever opens it — .exe, .bat, .sh, and Office files carrying macros — is refused, including files renamed to look like something else. Drawings, archives, video and everything else a site actually produces are fine.

21. Billing the client

An interim payment certificate is not one figure. It is the work certified for the period, the tax on it, the retention the client holds back, and whatever advance is being recovered — and the amount the client is asked for is what is left after all four. The system shows the four steps as you type them, so the figure is checked before it goes out rather than after it comes back queried.

- 1 Open **Finance** and go to the **Client invoices** tab.
- 2 Press **Raise a certificate**. Choose the project and give it a title — "IPA No. 3 — works to 25 August" reads better in six months than "Invoice 3".
- 3 Add a line for each item of work: what it is, the unit, the quantity and the rate.
- 4 Set the tax treatment, the retention percentage, and anything being recovered or deducted.
- 5 Check the working at the bottom of the form, then save it as a draft.
- 6 When you are satisfied, press **Issue** on the row. Nothing is owed by the client until you do.

The arithmetic is the system's, not the screen's

Every total on a certificate is worked out again on the server when you save it. The figures shown as you type are there so a person can check them — the company stands behind what is stored, and that is calculated in one place.

Standard VAT, SVAT and exempt

Treatment	What happens
Standard VAT	VAT is added at the rate you set and the client pays it with the invoice.
SVAT — suspended	The VAT is shown on the certificate but not collected. A credit voucher passes instead, so it is not part of what the client pays.
Exempt	No VAT at all.

If you record an SVAT certificate as standard, the system will show the client owing the VAT as well — and the money will be chased. Get this right at the point of raising it.

Money coming in

- 1 When a payment arrives, press **Record payment** on the invoice row.
- 2 Enter what was actually received, the date, and the bank reference.
- 3 The invoice moves to **Part paid** or **Paid** on its own, and the money is posted as project income at the same time. Do not also record it under Income — that would count it twice.

The **How long it has been owed** table underneath sorts what is outstanding into not yet due, one to thirty days, thirty-one to sixty, and over sixty. Anything in the last column has been owed for two months and somebody needs to make a phone call.

Retention

Retention is money the client keeps back against defects. It is deducted on every certificate and released later, so it is your money held elsewhere — the total across all live certificates is shown at the top of the tab so it is never forgotten.

Bank guarantees

The **Bonds** tab holds the advance payment, performance, retention and bid bonds the bank has issued on the company's behalf. Record each one with its expiry date and the margin the bank is holding against it.

Both ends of a bond matter

A bond that lapses while the contract is live is a breach the client can act on. A bond still live after the work is finished is the company's own cash sitting in the bank's account. The system warns about a bond within a month of expiry, and both of those are why.

22. Petty cash

Each site keeps a float for the small things — diesel, a courier, refreshments for a pour. The **Petty cash** tab under Finance keeps that float honest.

- 1 Press **Open a float** to start one: who holds it, which site, how much it holds, and the level at which it should be topped up.
- 2 Click the float's card to see everything that has moved through it.
- 3 Press **Record a movement** for each top-up, spend or return, with a description of what it was for.

The balance shown is always the sum of what has been recorded — it is never a figure somebody typed. A spend on a site is also posted as a cost against that project, so petty cash appears in the project's budget like every other cost. Spending more than the float holds is refused: record the top-up first.

23. The HR registers

Two views that HR offices are asked for by name. Neither holds anything new — it is the attendance and leave you already record, in the shape somebody needs it in.

The attendance register

Under **People**, the **Attendance register** tab is the muster roll: every employee down the side, every day of the month across, and a mark in each square.

Mark	Meaning
P	On site
L	Late — counted as present, but recorded as late
V	On approved leave
A	Absent
.	Nothing recorded for that person on that day

Change the month at the top. On a phone the roll scrolls sideways with the names held against the left edge, the way a paper roll is read.

The leave register

The **Leave register** tab shows a year at a time: annual and casual leave taken against what each person is entitled to, and what is left.

Pending days are counted separately

Days awaiting approval are shown in their own column, not folded into days taken. Somebody with two days left and three still pending is a conversation to have before the approval, not after it.

24. Lending tools out

Equipment leaves the store and does not always come back. The lending record now asks two more things, and both of them are the ones that get argued about later.

- 1 Open **Fleet & equipment** and go to the **Equipment** tab.
- 2 Press **Assign** on the row. Choose the project and the person responsible.
- 3 Set the **due back** date, and record the **condition on issue**.
- 4 When it returns, press **Return** and record the condition it came back in.

The register shows the due-back date on every item that is out, and anything past it is marked in red with how many days late it is. The store keeper and the site are both alerted, daily, until it comes back.

Record the condition both ways

A tool that goes out worn and comes back worn is nobody's fault. A tool that goes out good and comes back damaged is a conversation — but only if somebody wrote down that it went out good.

25. The evening summary

Every evening the system sends a short WhatsApp message summarising the day: how many people were on site, what was finished and what is overdue, what was spent and what came in, what is owed by clients, and anything that needs a decision.

- 1 Go to **Administration** and open the **Evening summary** tab.
- 2 The message shown is exactly what will be sent tonight, built from today's figures.
- 3 Press **Send it now** if it is wanted early, or to check the WhatsApp connection.

It goes to everybody holding the daily summary permission — normally the Managing Director — and only to those with a WhatsApp number on their account. Who receives it is changed under **Access control**, like every other permission.

26. If something looks wrong

What you see	What to do
The screen is not updating	Look under the bell for the small green dot. No dot means your internet has dropped. It reconnects on its own; if it does not, refresh the page.
A button is missing	Your role does not allow that action. Ask the Managing Director.
“Session expired”	You were signed out after an hour of inactivity. Sign in again.
A file will not upload	Check the file type. The system takes photographs, PDFs, Word and Excel files. It does not take programs or compressed files.
A search finds nothing	Try a different word. Remember that handwriting cannot be read. Very new uploads take a few seconds to become searchable.
A choice is missing from a dropdown	It can probably be added. See section 17, or ask somebody with Administration access.
A figure looks wrong	Do not correct it by working around it. Find where it was entered and fix it there, so every screen agrees.

Two habits worth keeping

- **Record things as they happen**, not at the end of the week. The system is only as good as what is put into it, and memory is not a reliable source.
- **If something looks wrong, say so.** A wrong figure that nobody mentions ends up in a quotation, an invoice, or a payslip.

For help with the system, contact the office. For changes to what you are allowed to do, contact the Managing Director.